

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 42 and 43

Making the Jumla Ismiyyah interrogative

1. The Kalimat ul Istifham

Istifham means to ask a question. In Arabic the *Kalimat ul Istifham* are used for asking, and they are of two kinds: the *Huroof ul Istifham* and the *Asma' ul Istifham*. Both come at the head of a *Jumla Ismiyyah* and of a *Jumla Fi'liyyah* alike.

The two basic kinds of question

Kind	Details	Formed by
1	questions that may be answered with yes or no — such as "is this a pen?"	Huroof ul Istifham
2	questions whose answer requires an explanation — such as "what is this?", where naming the thing is necessary	Asma' ul Istifham

2. The Huroof ul Istifham

Definition: For questions that may be answered with yes or no, the *Huroof ul Istifham* are placed at the head of the sentence. They **do not enter into any part of the sentence**, nor do they bring about any change in its structure; they simply turn the manner of the speech into a question.

Thus in أَهَذَا كِتَابٌ؟ the hamzah is the *Harf ul Istifham*, while هَذَا remains the *Mubtada* and كِتَابٌ the *Khabar* in their own places.

The *Huroof ul Istifham* are two.

2.1 The hamzah

The hamzah comes for *istifham*. Its vowel is **always a fathah**, and it is a *Hamzat ul Qat'*, an original hamzah. That is why, when read joined to the word before it, its vowel is pronounced and it does not fall away.

The verse	Translation
عَاثُكَ لَا تُؤْسَفُ	are you indeed Yusuf? — Surah Yusuf 90
عَاثُكُمْ تَزْرَعُونَهُ أَمْ نَحْنُ الزَّارِعُونَ	is it you who make it grow, or are We the grower? — Surah al-Waqi'ah 64
عَاثُكُمْ أَنشَأْتُمْ شَجَرَتَهَا أَمْ نَحْنُ الْمُنشِئُونَ	is it you who produced its tree, or are We the producer? — Surah al-Waqi'ah 72
أَلَمْ تَرَ كَيْفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ بِأَصْحَبِ الْفِيلِ	have you not seen how your Lord dealt with the companions of the elephant? — Surah al-Fil 1
أَلَمْ نَشْرَحْ لَكَ صَدْرَكَ	have We not expanded your breast for you? — Surah ash-Sharh 1

2.2 Hal

The verse	Translation
هَلْ أَتَاكَ حَدِيثُ الْعَاشِيَةِ	has there come to you the report of the overwhelming event? — Surah al-Ghashiyah 1
فَهَلْ تَرَى لَهُمْ مِّنْ بَاقِيَةٍ	then do you see any remnant of them? — Surah al-Haqqah 8
هَلْ تَرَى مِنْ فُطُورٍ	do you see any breaks? — Surah al-Mulk 3
هَلْ أَتَاكَ حَدِيثُ ضَيْفِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ الْمُكْرَمِينَ	has there come to you the report of the honoured guests of Ibrahim? — Surah adh-Dhariyat 24

Both these particles occur abundantly in the Qur'an.

An important difference between the hamzah and Hal

The difference: هَلْ enters only an **affirmative sentence**; it does not come at the head of a negative one. Against this, the hamzah enters a **negative sentence** as well.

This is why the Qur'an has أَلَمْ تَرَ and أَلَمْ نَشْرَحْ — in these the hamzah has entered a negative sentence. To say هَلْ لَمْ تَرَ would not have been sound.

Further senses of the hamzah: The hamzah does not always come for a real question. Sometimes it comes for *taqree*, drawing out an admission; sometimes for *inkar*, denial; and sometimes for *ta'ajjub*, wonder. In أَلَمْ نَشْرَحْ لَكَ صَدْرَكَ no question is intended; rather Allah is drawing from His Prophet an acknowledgement of His favour.

3. The Huroof ul Ijab — the particles of answer

Definition: The particles used to answer a question are called the *Huroof ul Ijab*.

Particle	Sense	Details
نَعَمْ	yes	it gives an affirmative answer. The I'raab or structure of the original sentence does not change; the answer is simply yes
لَا	no	this is the answer of negation. Here too the grammatical standing of the original sentence does not change; the answer is simply negative
بَلَى	yes indeed	this comes particularly in answer to a negative question, and it breaks the negation to establish the affirmative

Examples

فَتَحْتَ الْبَابَ — you opened the door

أَفَتَحْتَ الْبَابَ؟ — did you open the door?

لَا مَا فَتَحْتَ الْبَابَ — no! I did not open the door

أ / هَلْ قَرَأْتُمْ الْقُرْآنَ الْيَوْمَ؟ — have you all read the Qur'an today?

نَعَمْ! قَرَأْنَا الْقُرْآنَ الْيَوْمَ — yes, we have read the Qur'an today

The delicate difference between Bala and Na'am

The most important rule: When the question is **negative**, saying نَعَمْ in answer means **confirming the negation**, while saying بَلَى means **rejecting the negation**.

وَإِذْ أَخَذَ رَبُّكَ مِنْ بَنِي آدَمَ مِنْ ظُهُورِهِمْ ذُرِّيَّتَهُمْ وَأَشْهَدَهُمْ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ ۖ أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ ۖ قَالُوا بَلَى

(Surah al-A'raf: 172)

Translation: And when your Lord took from the children of Adam, from their loins, their descendants, and made them testify concerning themselves: am I not your Lord? They said: yes indeed.

Here the question is negative: أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ, "am I not your Lord?". Had نَعَمْ been said in answer, the meaning would have been "yes, You are not our Lord" — which would have been disbelief. That is why بَلَى was said, meaning "yes indeed, You certainly are our Lord".

A momentous point: The most fundamental testimony of belief rests upon the choice of a single word.
This is the fineness of the Arabic language.

رَعَمَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَنْ لَنْ يُبْعَثُوا ۚ قُلْ بَلَىٰ وَرَبِّي لَتُبْعَثُنَّ

(Surah at-Taghabun: 7)

Translation: Those who disbelieve claim that they will never be raised. Say: yes indeed, by my Lord, you will surely be raised.

4. The Asma' ul Istifham

Definition: A question that cannot be answered with yes or no but needs words to answer it — the nouns used in Arabic to form such questions are called the *Asma' ul Istifham*.

Four basic characteristics

- The *Asma' ul Istifham* become part of the Jumla Ismiyyah — either as *Mubtada* or as *Khabar*.
- They are always *Nakirah*, that is, indeterminate.
- There is no restriction of gender or number — except in *أَيُّ*.
- All the *Asma' ul Istifham* are *Mabni*; only *أَيُّ* is *Mu'rab*.

Mubtada or Khabar?: There are two views on this. Some hold that the *Asma' ul Istifham* become the *Mubtada*; others hold that since they are not among the categories of the *Ma'rifah*, they become the *Khabar*.

5. The nine Asma' ul Istifham

5.1 Ma — what

- It comes for *Ghayr Dhawi al-'Uqool*, things without intellect.
- In respect of *wus'at* it is *Nakirah*.
- In respect of number it stays the same for singular, dual and plural alike.
- In respect of gender it is used alike for masculine and feminine.
- Being *Mabni*, its form does not change in *raf'*, *nasb* or *jarr*.

The verse	Translation
مَا الْحَاقَّةُ	what is the inevitable reality? — Surah al-Haqqah 2
وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الْحَاقَّةُ	and what can make you know what the inevitable reality is? — Surah al-Haqqah 3
وَمَا تِلْكَ بِيَمِينِكَ يُمُوسَى	and what is that in your right hand, O Musa? — Surah Ta-Ha 17
مَا لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ	what is the Night of Decree? — Surah al-Qadr 2

A necessary difference: مَا of negation is a *Harf*, while the مَا that comes for *istifham* is an *Ism*.

5.2 Man — who

It comes for *Dhawi al-'Uqool*, those possessed of intellect.

The verse	Translation
مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يُقْرِضُ اللَّهَ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا	who is it that will lend Allah a goodly loan? — Surah al-Baqarah 245
مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ	who is it that can intercede with Him except by His permission? — Surah al-Baqarah 255

5.3 Kayfa — how

This is used for asking about someone's state or condition.

The verse	Translation
وَكَيْفَ تَصْبِرُ عَلَىٰ مَا لَمْ تُحِطْ بِهِ خُبْرًا	and how can you have patience over what you do not encompass in knowledge? — Surah al-Kahf 68
فَكَيْفَ إِذَا أَصَابَتْهُمْ مُصِيبَةٌ	then how will it be when a calamity strikes them? — Surah an-Nisa 62
كَيْفَ خَلَقَ اللَّهُ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ طِبَاقًا	how did Allah create seven heavens in layers? — Surah Nuh 15
كَيْفَ نُكَلِّمُ مَنْ كَانَ فِي الْمَهْدِ صَبِيًا	how can we speak to one who is an infant in the cradle? — Surah Maryam 29

5.4 Mata — when

This is used for asking about time.

The verse	Translation
مَتَىٰ هَذَا الْوَعْدُ إِن كُنتُمْ صَادِقِينَ	when is this promise, if you are truthful? — Surah al-Mulk 25
مَتَىٰ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ	when will the help of Allah come? — Surah al-Baqarah 214
مَتَىٰ هَذَا الْفَتْحُ إِن كُنتُمْ صَادِقِينَ	when will this decision be, if you are truthful? — Surah as-Sajdah 28
وَيَقُولُونَ مَتَىٰ هُوَ قُلْ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونَ قَرِيبًا	and they say: when is it? Say: perhaps it is near — Surah Bani Isra'il 51

5.5 Ayyana — when

اَيَّانَ also gives the sense of "when", but it is generally used for asking about the time of **some great and momentous thing**.

The verse	Translation
يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ السَّاعَةِ أَيَّانَ مُرْسُهَا	they ask you about the Hour: when is its arrival? — Surah an-Nazi'at 42
أَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الْقِيَمَةِ	when is the Day of Resurrection? — Surah al-Qiyamah 6
أَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ	when is the Day of Recompense? — Surah adh-Dhariyat 12

The difference between Mata and Ayyana: **مَتَى** may be used to ask about matters both great and small. Whereas **أَيَّانَ** is used to ask only about **momentous matters in time to come**.

5.6 Ayna — where

أَيْنَ comes for asking about place, as in **أَيْنَ أَنْتَ؟**, "where are you?"

The verse	Translation
أَيْنَ مَا كُنْتُمْ تَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ	where are those you used to call upon besides Allah? — Surah al-A'raf 37
يَقُولُ الْإِنْسَانُ يَوْمَئِذٍ أَيْنَ الْمَفَرُّ	man will say that day: where is the place of escape? — Surah al-Qiyamah 10
أَيْنَ شُرَكَائِي	where are My partners? — Surah Fussilat 47

5.7 Anna — from where, how

It also gives the sense of **مِنْ أَيْنَ**.

قَالَ يَمْرَيْمُ أَيْ لَكَ هَذَا قَالَتْ هُوَ مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 37)

Translation: He said: O Maryam, from where have you this? She said: it is from Allah.

The verse	Translation
أَيْ يَكُونُ لِي غُلَمٌ	how can I have a boy? — Surah Al 'Imran 40
أَيْ لَهُمُ الذِّكْرَى	how can there be for them a reminder? — Surah ad-Dukhan 13

5.8 Kam — how many

كَمْ is of two kinds, and both are rendered "how many" or "how many a" — but there is a difference of principle between them.

Kind	The noun that follows it	Example
Kam Istifhamiyyah	is always singular, Mansoob and Nakirah	كَمْ طَالِبًا فِي الْفَصْلِ؟ (how many students are in the class?)
Kam Khabariyyah	may be singular or plural, but is necessarily Majroor, and may be Nakirah or Ma'rifah. It comes with a verb to state a report or an abundance	كَمْ مِنْ طَالِبٍ فِي الْفَصْلِ (how many a student there is in the class)

The verse	Translation
كَمْ لَبِثْتُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ عَدَدَ سِنِينَ	how many years did you remain on the earth? — Surah al-Mu'minun 112
قَالَ كَمْ لَبِثْتَ	He said: how long did you remain? — Surah al-Baqarah 259

5.9 Ayyun — which

It is used for both *Dhawi al-'Uqool* and *Ghayr Dhawi al-'Uqool*, and its grammatical characteristics differ from all the rest.

- In respect of *wus'at* it is *Nakirah*.
- In number it comes for singular, dual and plural alike.
- In gender, *أَيُّ* is used for the masculine and *أَيَّةُ* for the feminine.
- In I'raab it is *Mu'rab*: *أَيُّ* in *raf'*, *أَيِّ* in *nasb*, and *أَيِّ* in *jarr*.
- It is always used as a *Mudaf*, as in *أَيُّ كِتَابٍ هَذَا؟*, where *أَيُّ* is the *Mudaf* and *كِتَابٍ* the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

The verse	Translation
أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا	which of you is best in deed? — Surah al-Mulk 2
فَبِأَيِّ آلَاءِ رَبِّكُمَا تُكَذِّبَنِ	so which of the favours of your Lord will you two deny? — Surah ar-Rahman 13
بِأَيِّكُمْ الْمَفْتُونُ	which of you is the afflicted one? — Surah al-Qalam 6
مِنْ أَيِّ شَيْءٍ خَلَقَهُ	from what thing did He create him? — Surah 'Abasa 18
لِأَيِّ يَوْمٍ أُجِّلَتْ	for what day was it postponed? — Surah al-Mursalat 12

6. The standing of the Asma' ul Istifham in a Jumla Ismiyyah

An easy test: The *Asma' ul Istifham* may be either the *Mubtada* or the *Khabar* in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*. The easy way to know which is to **look at the answer**. Whatever word is the *Mubtada* in the answer, the interrogative noun standing in its place in the question will be the *Mubtada* too; and whatever is the *Khabar* there will be the *Khabar* here.

6.1 When the interrogative noun is the Khabar

Question	Answer	Analysis
مَا هَذَا؟	هَذَا قَلَمٌ	in the answer قَلَمٌ is the Khabar, so in the question مَا is the Khabar Muqaddam and هَذَا the Mubtada Mu'akhkhar
كَيْفَ حَالُكَ؟	حَالِي جَيِّدٌ	in the answer جَيِّدٌ is the Khabar, so كَيْفَ is the Khabar Muqaddam

The particular ruling on Kayfa: كَيْفَ is always the Khabar.

Examples from the Qur'an

وَمَا تِلْكَ بِيَمِينِكَ يُمُوسَى

(Surah Ta-Ha: 17)

Translation: And what is that in your right hand, O Musa?

Here مَا is the *Khabar Muqaddam*, تِلْكَ the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*, and بِيَمِينِكَ a *jarr* with its *majroor* as the *Muta'alliq ul Khabar*. Musa, peace be upon him, answered: هِيَ عَصَايَ, "it is my staff".

مَنْ أَنْصَارِي إِلَى اللَّهِ

(Surah as-Saff: 14)

Translation: Who are my supporters for Allah?

Here مَنْ is the *Khabar Muqaddam* and أَنْصَارِي the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*.

6.2 When the interrogative noun is the Mubtada

Question	Answer	Analysis
مَا فِي يَدِكَ؟	فِي يَدَيَّ قَلَمٌ	in the answer قَلَمٌ is the Mubtada Mu'akhkhar, so in the question مَا becomes the Mubtada
مَنْ فِي الْعُرْفَةِ؟	فِي الْعُرْفَةِ زَيْدٌ	in the answer زَيْدٌ is the Mubtada, so in the question مَنْ is also the Mubtada

Question	Answer	Analysis
كَمْ ابْنًا لَكَ؟	لِي ابْنٌ	in the answer ابْنٌ is the Mubtada, so in the question كَمْ ابْنًا is the Mubtada and لَكَ the Khabar

6.3 Ayyun may be either

Question	Answer	Analysis
أَيُّ شَيْءٍ هَذَا؟	هَذَا قَلَمٌ	in the answer قَلَمٌ is the Khabar, so أَيُّ شَيْءٍ is the Khabar Muqaddam and هَذَا the Mubtada Mu'akhkhar
أَيُّ الْبِلَادِ أَحْسَنُ؟	لَاهُورٌ أَحْسَنُ	in the answer لَاهُورٌ is the Mubtada, so in the question أَيُّ الْبِلَادِ is the Mubtada and أَحْسَنُ the Khabar

7. The four that convey the sense of a Zarf

Four of the *Asma' ul Istifham* convey the sense of a *zarf*.

Zarf uz Zaman	Zarf ul Makan
مَتَى • أَيَّانَ	أَيْنَ • أَى

Their ruling: The *zuroof* used in a *Jumla Ismiyyah* are always *mahallan Mansoob*, and like a *Murakkab Jarri* they become the *Muta'alliq* in the sentence, or, where the *Khabar* is absent, the *Qa'im Maqam Khabar*.

This rule was met before: The very principle of the *zarf* being *mahallan Mansoob* and becoming the *Muta'alliq* or the *Qa'im Maqam Khabar* was studied in detail in Lectures 33 and 34.

Qur'anic analyses

يَقُولُ الْإِنْسَانُ يَوْمَئِذٍ أَيْنَ الْمَفَرُّ

(Surah al-Qiyamah: 10)

Translation: Man will say that day: where is the place of escape?

Here أَيْنَ is the *Khabar Muqaddam* and الْمَفَرُّ the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*.

مَتَى نَصْرُ اللَّهِ

Its answer is in the Qur'an itself: أَلَا إِنَّ نَصْرَ اللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ — "unquestionably, the help of Allah is near". In the answer نَصْرُ اللَّهِ is the *Mubtada*, so in the question مَتَى is a *zarf, mahallan Mansoob*, standing as the *Khabar Muqaddam*.

يَسْأَلُ أَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الْقِيَمَةِ

(Surah al-Qiyamah: 6)

Translation: He asks: when is the Day of Resurrection?

Here يَوْمُ الْقِيَمَةِ is the *Mubtada* and أَيَّانَ the *Khabar Muqaddam*.

And in the question of Zakariyya, peace be upon him, أَى يَمْرَأَتِي هَذَا is the *Khabar Muqaddam* and هَذَا the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*.

8. Compound forms with the Huroof ul Jarr

Rule: When the interrogative مَا comes with the *Huroof ul Jarr* بِ, لِ, فِي, مِنْ or عَنْ, its alif is dropped.

Compound	How it came about	Meaning
بِمَ	بِ + مَا	with what
لِمَ	لِ + مَا	why
فِيْمَ	فِي + مَا	in what, in what state
مِمَّ	where both the مَا, مِنْ and the alif fell	from what
عَمَّ	where the مَا, عَنْ and the noon fell	about what
لِمَنْ	لِ + مَنْ	for whom

Examples from the Qur'an

وَإِنِّي مُرْسِلَةٌ إِلَيْهِمْ بِهَدِيَّةٍ فَنَاظِرَةٌ بِمَ يَرْجِعُ الْمُرْسَلُونَ

(Surah an-Naml: 35)

Translation: And I am going to send them a gift and see with what the envoys return.

قَالَ رَبِّ لِمَ حَشَرْتَنِي أَعْمَى وَقَدْ كُنْتُ بَصِيرًا

(Surah Ta-Ha: 125)

Translation: He will say: my Lord, why have You raised me blind, while I used to see?

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لِمَ تَقُولُونَ مَا لَا تَفْعَلُونَ

(Surah as-Saff: 2)

Translation: O you who believe, why do you say what you do not do?

عَمَّ يَتَسَاءَلُونَ

(Surah an-Naba: 1)

Translation: About what are they asking one another?

قَالُوا فِيْمَ كُنْتُمْ

(Surah an-Nisa: 97)

Translation: They will say: in what condition were you?

فِيْمَ أَنْتَ مِنْ ذِكْرِهَا

(Surah an-Nazi'at: 43)

Translation: In what position are you to mention it?

فَلْيَنْظُرِ الْإِنْسَانُ مِمَّ خُلِقَ

(Surah at-Tariq: 5)

Translation: So let man observe from what he was created.

A necessary difference: If مِمَّا appears with the alif, it is no longer interrogative but gives the sense of "that which". It is the dropping of the alif that makes it a question.

لِمَنِ الْمُلْكُ الْيَوْمَ ۖ لِلَّهِ الْوَاحِدِ الْقَهَّارِ

(Surah Ghafir: 16)

Translation: To whom belongs the dominion this Day? To Allah, the One, the Prevailing.

Summary

1. Istifham means to ask a question, and the Kalimat ul Istifham are of two kinds: the Huroof ul Istifham and the Asma' ul Istifham.
2. For questions answered with yes or no the Huroof ul Istifham come; for those needing explanation, the Asma' ul Istifham.
3. The Huroof ul Istifham do not enter into any part of the sentence nor change its structure; they only make the manner interrogative.
4. The Huroof ul Istifham are two: the hamzah and هَلْ.
5. The vowel of the hamzah is always a fathah, and it is a Hamzat ul Qat', so it does not fall away even when read joined.
6. هَلْ enters only an affirmative sentence, while the hamzah enters a negative one too, as in أَلَمْ تَرَ.
7. The hamzah sometimes comes not for a real question but for taqreer, inkar or ta'ajjub.
8. The particles of answer are called the Huroof ul Ijab: بَلَى and نَعَمْ, لَا.
9. نَعَمْ gives an affirmative and لَا a negative answer, and neither changes the structure of the original sentence.
10. In answer to a negative question نَعَمْ confirms the negation, while بَلَى rejects it.
11. In answer to أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ they said قَالُوا بَلَى, since saying نَعَمْ would have reversed the meaning.
12. The Asma' ul Istifham become part of the Jumla Ismiyyah, and they are always Nakirah.
13. All the Asma' ul Istifham are Mabni; only أَيُّ is Mu'rab.
14. مَا comes for Ghayr Dhawi al-'Uqool and مَنْ for Dhawi al-'Uqool.
15. مَا of negation is a Harf, while the مَا of istifham is an Ism.
16. كَيْفَ asks about a state, مَتَى and أَيَّانَ about time, and أَيْنَ and أَيْ about place.
17. مَتَى may ask about matters great and small, but أَيَّانَ only about momentous ones.
18. After Kam Istifhamiyyah the noun is singular, Mansoob and Nakirah; after Kam Khabariyyah it is Majroor.
19. أَيُّ is always used as a Mudaf, and أَيَّةُ is used for the feminine.
20. The way to know the standing of an interrogative noun is to look at the answer.
21. كَيْفَ is always the Khabar, while مَنْ, مَتَى, مَا, and أَيُّ may be either Mu'tada or Khabar.
22. In مَا تِلْكَ بِمِثْلِكَ, مَا is the Khabar Muqaddam and تِلْكَ the Mu'tada Mu'akhkhar.
23. Four of the Asma' ul Istifham convey the sense of a zarf: مَتَى and أَيَّانَ of time, أَيْنَ and أَيْ of place.
24. In a Jumla Ismiyyah the zuroof are always mahallan Mansoob and become the Muta'alliq or the Qa'im Maqam Khabar.
25. When the interrogative مَا comes with the Huroof ul Jarr its alif is dropped: لِمَ, لِمَ, فِيمَ, مِمَّ, عَمَّ.
26. If مِمَّا appears with the alif it is no longer interrogative but gives the sense of "that which".

Exercise

1. Write the meaning of Istifham and describe both kinds of the Kalimat ul Istifham.
2. Explain both basic kinds of question with examples.
3. Define the Huroof ul Istifham and state what change they bring to a sentence.
4. Write the characteristics of the interrogative hamzah and give three Qur'anic examples.
5. What is the difference between the hamzah and هَلْ?
6. Write the three further senses of the hamzah.
7. Which are the Huroof ul Ijab? State the sense of each.
8. What is the difference between نَعَمْ and بَلَى in answer to a negative question?
9. Why was بَلَى said in answer to أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ?
10. Write all four characteristics of the Asma' ul Istifham.
11. What is the difference in the use of مَا and مَنْ?
12. State the difference between مَا of negation and مَا of istifham.
13. What is the difference between مَتَى and أَيَّانَ?
14. Explain with examples the difference between Kam Istifhamiyyah and Kam Khabariyyah.
15. Write all five characteristics of أَيُّ.
16. What is the easy way of knowing the standing of an interrogative noun?
17. Give a full analysis of وَمَا تَلْكَ بِيَمِينِكَ.
18. What is the particular ruling on كَيْفَ?
19. Write the four nouns that convey the sense of a zarf and state their ruling.
20. Analyse مَتَى نَصَرَ اللَّهُ and write its answer from the Qur'an as well.
21. Set out in a table the compound forms of مَا with the Huroof ul Jarr.
22. What is the difference between مِمَّا and مِمَّ?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ